

SIMATS Engineering

SIMATS Online Programming Lab — Python Programming (Mock Interview)

Course Name	Python Programming
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Topic	CO3-AT3-MOCK INTERVIEW
Question	Q4 — Python Set Operations (10 Marks)

Q4. [10 Marks] Demonstrate all six set operations: union (`|`), intersection (`&`), difference (`-`), symmetric difference (`^`), `issubset` (`<=`), and `issuperset` (`>=`) with $A=\{1,2,3,4,5\}$ and $B=\{3,4,5,6,7\}$.

Answer

A Python set is an unordered collection of unique, hashable elements that supports fast membership testing and provides built-in operators that directly mirror the mathematical set operations. Given $A = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ and $B = \{3, 4, 5, 6, 7\}$, each of the six operations is demonstrated below.

1. Union (`|`)

$A | B$ returns a new set containing every element that appears in A, in B, or in both, with duplicates naturally collapsed since a set cannot hold repeated values. Result: $A | B = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7\}$.

2. Intersection (`&`)

$A \& B$ returns only the elements common to both sets. Result: $A \& B = \{3, 4, 5\}$.

3. Difference (`-`)

$A - B$ returns the elements present in A but not in B; this operation is not symmetric, so $B - A$ gives a different result. Result: $A - B = \{1, 2\}$, while $B - A = \{6, 7\}$.

4. Symmetric difference (`^`)

$A \wedge B$ returns the elements that are in exactly one of the two sets, but not in both — equivalent to $(A - B)$ union $(B - A)$, or the union minus the intersection. Result: $A \wedge B = \{1, 2, 6, 7\}$.

5. `issubset` (`<=`)

$A \leq B$ (or `A.issubset(B)`) checks whether every element of A is also present in B. Since A contains 1 and 2, which are not in B, A is not a subset of B. Result: $A \leq B$ is False. As a further example, $\{1, 2, 3\} \leq A$ is True, since every element of $\{1, 2, 3\}$ is present in A.

6. `issuperset` (`>=`)

$A \geq B$ (or `A.issuperset(B)`) checks whether A contains every element of B. Since B contains 6 and 7, which are not in A, A is not a superset of B. Result: $A \geq B$ is False. As a further example, $A \geq \{1, 2, 3\}$ is True, since A contains all of 1, 2, and 3.

Python Program

```

"""
C03-AT3 - Mock Interview
Q4: Python Set Operations [10 Marks]
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Demonstrates union, intersection, difference, symmetric
difference, issubset, and issuperset using A and B.
"""

A = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5}
B = {3, 4, 5, 6, 7}

print("A:", A)
print("B:", B)

# 1. Union
print("Union (A | B):", A | B)

# 2. Intersection
print("Intersection (A & B):", A & B)

# 3. Difference
print("Difference (A - B):", A - B)
print("Difference (B - A):", B - A)

# 4. Symmetric difference
print("Symmetric difference (A ^ B):", A ^ B)

# 5. issubset
print("A issubset B (A <= B):", A <= B)
print("{1,2,3} issubset A:", {1, 2, 3} <= A)

# 6. issuperset
print("A issuperset B (A >= B):", A >= B)
print("A issuperset {1,2,3}:", A >= {1, 2, 3})

```

Sample Output

```

A: {1, 2, 3, 4, 5}
B: {3, 4, 5, 6, 7}
Union (A | B): {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7}
Intersection (A & B): {3, 4, 5}
Difference (A - B): {1, 2}
Difference (B - A): {6, 7}
Symmetric difference (A ^ B): {1, 2, 6, 7}
A issubset B (A <= B): False
{1,2,3} issubset A: True
A issuperset B (A >= B): False
A issuperset {1,2,3}: True

```

Conclusion

Python's set type provides direct operator support for all standard mathematical set operations, making set-based logic concise and readable. With $A = \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ and $B = \{3, 4, 5, 6, 7\}$, the union combines all distinct elements from both sets, the intersection isolates the shared elements $\{3, 4, 5\}$, the difference operators show what belongs to one set but not the other, and the symmetric difference captures everything that is not shared. The `issubset` and `issuperset` checks confirm that neither A nor B fully contains the other, since each has elements the other lacks, while smaller subsets such as $\{1, 2, 3\}$ correctly test as being contained within A. Together these six operations demonstrate how Python sets closely follow standard set theory while remaining simple to use in

code.